ONI DOJO 鬼道場

N2

JLPT N2 Workbook

Work, news and opinions

Formal written patterns, set expressions and the vocabulary of work, society and argument.

30	89	357	8	784
LESSONS	GRAMMAR POINTS	WORDS	READINGS	EXERCISES

with Kurenai 紅 · Slettvold Security · slettvold.org

How to use this workbook

> *“Welcome to my dojo. I am Kurenai, your sensei, and yes, I am an oni. Don't worry, I only bite lazy students. Work through one lesson at a time, write your answers by hand, and check them at the back. Then do it again in a week. That's the whole secret.”*

1. **Read the grammar.** Each point has a short explanation and examples. Read the examples aloud.
2. **Learn the words.** Tick the box when you know a word without looking.
3. **Read the dialogue** and cover the English to see how much you understand.
4. **Do the practice** on paper without looking back, then check your answers in the answer key.
5. **Read the stories** placed between the lessons. They only use what you have learned so far.
6. **Review.** Come back to a lesson after a few days and a week. Spaced review is what makes words stick.

Furigana (small kana above kanji) is shown in grammar, dialogues and stories. Try reading without it first. In the practice sections there is less help, as in the real test.

This workbook follows the N2 course in the **Oni Dojo** app (slettvold.org/onidojo), where every sentence also has audio, flashcards and typed answers. You can use the book on its own or together with the app.

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the selection here follows common practice.

N2 · LESSON 1

Although, granted ものの・とはいえ・といっても

In this lesson you will

- Concede a point with ～ものの
- Use the written ～とはいえ
- Downplay with ～といっても

Grammar

1 ～ものの *although …, but …*

Plain form (な-adj である/な, noun である) + ものの: the first fact is true, but the result is not what you'd expect: 免許は取ったものの、車がない "I got my licence, but I don't have a car". It's written or formal; in speech use けど.

日本語を勉強し始めたものの、なかなか続かない。	I started studying Japanese, but I can't seem to keep it up.
新しい仕事に慣れてきたものの、まだ不安なことも多い。	I've got used to the new job, but there's still a lot I'm unsure about.
頭ではわかっているものの、実行するのは難しい。	I understand it in my head, but putting it into practice is hard.

2 ～とはいえ *even so, granted that …*

Plain form or noun + とはいえ: admits a fact, then contradicts the expectation. Very common in writing: 春とはいえ、まだ寒い "It's spring, but it's still cold". At the start of a sentence: とはいえ、… "That said, …".

春とはいえ、朝晩はまだ寒い。	It may be spring, but mornings and evenings are still cold.
簡単な仕事とはいえ、油断はできない。	It may be simple work, but you can't let your guard down.
景気は回復しつつある。とはいえ、生活は楽にならない。	The economy is recovering. Even so, life isn't getting easier.

3 ～といっても *although I say …, (it's not much)*

といっても corrects an impression: 料理ができるといっても、カレーぐらいです "I say I can cook, but it's only curry". It lowers what was just said.

旅行といっても、近くの温泉に一泊するだけです。	I say "a trip", but it's just one night at a nearby hot spring.
社長といっても、社員三人の小さな会社だ。	He's a company president, but it's a small firm with three employees.

Vocabulary

WORD	READING	MEANING	✓
免許	めんきょ	licence	☐
実行	じっこう	carrying out, practice	☐
不安	ふあん	anxiety	☐
朝晩	あさばん	morning and evening	☐
油断	ゆだん	carelessness	☐
景気	けいき	economic conditions	☐
回復	かいふく	recovery	☐
楽	らく	easy, comfortable	☐
一泊	いっぱく	one night's stay	☐
社員	しゃいん	employee	☐
理想	りそう	ideal	☐
現実	げんじつ	reality	☐
矛盾	むじゅん	contradiction	☐
譲歩	じょうほ	concession	☐
挑戦	ちょうせん	challenge	☐

Dialogue: The N2 wall

You return to the dojo after a long break.

紅 久しぶりね。N2の勉強は進んでる？

Long time no see. How's your N2 study going?

あなた 教科書は買ったものの、まだ三ページしか読んでいません……。

I bought the textbook, but I've only read three pages…

紅 忙しいとはいえ、三ページは少なすぎるわね。

Even if you're busy, three pages is too few.

あなた 忙しいといっても、ゲームをしていただけなんですが。

Well, I say busy, but I was just playing games.

紅 正直でよろしい。今日から、また鬼の修行よ。

Honest, at least. Starting today, it's oni training again.

Kurenai's culture corner

Many learners hit a "plateau" between N3 and N2: textbooks get abstract, and progress feels slow. Japanese has a word for steady effort through it — 地道 (じみち, "plain, steady") — and N2 is often the level employers ask for, so the reward is real.

Practice

1.1 Match the word to its meaning

Match each Japanese word with its English meaning.

1. _____ 油断
2. _____ 挑戦
3. _____ 現実
4. _____ 実行
5. _____ 朝晩
6. _____ 矛盾
7. _____ 社員
8. _____ 一泊
9. _____ 免許
10. _____ 回復

a one night's stay
b licence
c carrying out, practice
d recovery
e carelessness
f morning and evening
g reality
h challenge
i contradiction
j employee

1.2 Choose the right word

Choose the word that fills the blank ____.

1. 免許(めんきょ)は取(と)った____、車(くるま)がない。 (I got my licence, but no car.)

   a からには **b** ものなら **c** ものの **d** といっても

2. 春(はる)と____、まだ寒(さむ)い。 (It's spring, but still cold.)

   a しても **b** すれば **c** はいえ **d** いっても

3. 旅行(りょこう)と____、一泊(いっぱく)だけです。 (I say trip, but just one night.)

   a しても **b** いっても **c** はいえ **d** すれば

4. 頭(あたま)ではわかっている____、実行(じっこう)は難(むずか)しい。 (I know it, but doing it is hard.)

   a もの **b** ものだ **c** もので **d** ものの

5. 簡単(かんたん)な仕事(しごと)とは____、油断(ゆだん)できない。 (Simple work, yet you can't relax.)

   a いって **b** いうと **c** いえ **d** いえば

6. 社長(しゃちょう)と____、社員三人(しゃいんさんにん)の会社(かいしゃ)だ。 (He's president, but of a tiny firm.)

   a したら **b** いっても **c** すれば **d** なると

1.3 Translate into Japanese

Write each sentence in Japanese (kana is fine), then check against the model answer.

1. I started, but I can't keep it up.

2. It's spring, but it's still cold.

3. I say I can cook, but only curry.

4. That said, life isn't easy.

1.4 Understand the dialogue

Match each line from the dialogue to its meaning.

1. _____ 久しぶりね。N2の勉強は進んでる？
2. _____ 教科書は買ったものの、まだ三ページしか読んでいません……。
3. _____ 忙しいとはいえ、三ページは少なすぎるわね。
4. _____ 忙しいといっても、ゲームをしていただけなんですが。
5. _____ 正直でよろしい。今日から、また鬼の修行よ。

a Well, I say busy, but I was just playing games.

b I bought the textbook, but I've only read three pages…

c Honest, at least. Starting today, it's oni training again.

d Long time no see. How's your N2 study going?

e Even if you're busy, three pages is too few.

N2 · LESSON 2

If only, because (excuses) ものなら・ものだから

In this lesson you will

- Express an impossible wish with ～ものなら
- Warn of consequences with ～ようものなら
- Give excuses with ～ものだから／～もので

Grammar

1 ～ものなら *if (it were) possible …*

Potential form + ものなら: a wish that's hard to achieve: 戻れるものなら、学生時代に戻りたい "If I could go back, I'd go back to my student days". The second half is often a wish or challenge: できるものならやってみろ "Do it, if you can".

行けるものなら、今すぐ日本へ行きたい。	If I could, I'd go to Japan right now.
やり直せるものなら、やり直したい。	If I could start over, I would.

2 ～ようものなら *if (you dare to) …, (disaster)*

Volitional + ものなら warns that even a small action would bring terrible results: 母に口答えしようものなら、一週間口をきいてもらえない "If I so much as talk back to my mother, she won't speak to me for a week".

この店で写真を撮ろうものなら、すぐに怒られる。	If you so much as take a photo in this shop, you'll get told off immediately.
先生に遅刻しようものなら、大変なことになる。	If you're late for Sensei, you're in big trouble.

3 ～ものだから／～もので *because (excuse, explanation)*

Plain form (な-adj な, noun な) + ものだから gives a personal reason, often as an excuse or apology: 道が混んでいたものですから、遅れてしまいました "The roads were busy, so I'm afraid I was late". もので is softer and very common in polite speech.

電車が止まっていたものですから、遅くなりました。	The trains were stopped, so I'm late.
あまりにおいしかったもので、つい全部食べてしまいました。	It was so delicious that I ended up eating it all.
初めてなもので、よくわからないんです。	It's my first time, so I don't really understand.

Vocabulary

WORD	READING	MEANING	✓
やり直す	やりなおす	redo, start over	☐
口答え	くちごたえ	talking back	☐
口をきく	くちをきく	speak to	☐
あまりに		too, excessively	☐
言い訳	いいわけ	excuse	☐
事情	じじょう	circumstances	☐
遠慮	えんりょ	restraint, holding back	☐
恐縮	きょうしゅく	feeling obliged/sorry	☐
願望	がんぼう	wish, desire	☐
時間を巻き戻す	じかんをまきもどす	turn back time	☐
取り返し	とりかえし	recovery (of a mistake)	☐
激怒	げきど	fury	☐
慌てる	あわてる	panic, rush	☐
うっかり		carelessly	☐

Dialogue: The late arrival

You arrive 30 minutes late to a meeting with Kurenai's friend.

あなた 申し訳ありません。電車が遅れていたものですから……。

I'm terribly sorry. The train was delayed…

紅 天狗さんは時間に厳しいの。一分でも遅れようものなら、山に帰ってしまうわ。

Tengu-san is strict about time. If you're even one minute late, he goes back to the mountains.

あなた えっ、もう帰ってしまったんですか。

What, has he already gone?

紅 ええ。時間を戻せるものなら、戻してあげたいけど。

Yes. If I could turn back time, I would for you.

あなた 次は一時間前に来ます……。

Next time I'll come an hour early…

Kurenai's culture corner

In Japanese apologies, explaining circumstances (事情) is fine, but the apology must come first: 申し訳ありません, then the reason with ものですから. Starting with the reason sounds like you're dodging responsibility (言い訳).

Practice

2.1 Match the word to its meaning

Match each Japanese word with its English meaning.

1. _____ 言い訳
2. _____ 戻る
3. _____ あまりに
4. _____ 遠慮
5. _____ 取り返し
6. _____ 事情
7. _____ 激怒
8. _____ やり直す
9. _____ うっかり
10. _____ 口をきく

a restraint, holding back
b fury
c circumstances
d speak to
e too, excessively
f redo, start over
g carelessly
h recovery (of a mistake)
i excuse
j return

2.2 Choose the right word

Choose the word that fills the blank ____.

1. 戻れる____、学生時代に戻りたい。 (If I could go back…)

   a ものだから **b** ものの **c** ものか **d** ものなら

2. 母に口答えしよう____、大変だ。 (If I dared talk back to Mum…)

   a ものなら **b** もので **c** ものか **d** ものの

3. 電車が止まっていた____、遅くなりました。 (The train stopped, so I'm late.)

   a ものの **b** ものなら **c** ものですから **d** ものか

4. 初めてな____、よくわからないんです。 (It's my first time, so…)

   a もので **b** ものの **c** ものを **d** ものなら

5. 一分でも遅れ____ものなら、帰ってしまう。 (If you're even a minute late…)

   a ない **b** た **c** よう **d** る

6. やり直せる____、やり直したい。 (If I could start over, I would.)

   a ものなら **b** もので **c** ものの **d** ものだ

2.3 Translate into Japanese

Write each sentence in Japanese (kana is fine), then check against the model answer.

1. If I could, I'd go back to my student days.

2. The train was late, so I'm late.

3. It's my first time, so I don't understand.

4. If you dare be late, you're in trouble.

2.4 Understand the dialogue

Match each line from the dialogue to its meaning.

1. _____ 申し訳ありません。電車が遅れていたものですから……。
2. _____ 天狗さんは時間に厳しいの。一分でも遅れようものなら、山に帰ってしまうわ。
3. _____ えっ、もう帰ってしまったんですか。
4. _____ ええ。時間を戻せるものなら、戻してあげたいけど。
5. _____ 次は一時間前に来ます……。

a What, has he already gone?

b Yes. If I could turn back time, I would for you.

c Tengu-san is strict about time. If you're even one minute late, he goes back to the mountains.

d Next time I'll come an hour early…

e I'm terribly sorry. The train was delayed…

続く…

That was lessons 1 and 2 of 30 lessons.

“Not bad, pupil. The full JLPT N2 workbook has every lesson, every reading, the complete answer key and the word list. Come and get it, I'll be waiting.” — Kurenai

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